

Brian Kim

📍 College Park, MD

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Education

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| <p>PhD University of California, Los Angeles, Statistics</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Dissertation: Population Size Estimation using Multiple Respondent-Driven Samples | <p>Los Angeles, CA
Sept 2012 – Oct 2017</p> |
| <p>BA Amherst College, Mathematics & Philosophy</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Graduated with Honors in Mathematics Thesis: Using Mode Identification Clustering Methods with Pitch F/X Data | <p>Amherst, MA
Sept 2008 – June 2012</p> |

Research Interests

- Data Science Education; Social Network Analysis; Network Sampling Methods; Respondent-Driven Sampling; Population Size Estimation: Capture-Recapture and Multiple List methods; Social Science Applications of Machine Learning

Experience

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| <p>Co-Director, Social Data Science Major
<i>College of Behavioral and Social Sciences (BSOS), University of Maryland</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Led the development of a new major in Social Data Science (officially launched Fall 2022), including working across departments to build an appropriate curriculum, managing the budget, and setting up infrastructure. Developed new courses to be part of Social Data Science, including SDSB233: Data Science for Social Sciences and SDSB326: Python Programming for Social Science. Launched a new undergraduate Data Curation Fellowship experience in which students identify, obtain, clean, and curate datasets to be used within social science courses, with a public-facing data resource webpage. Coordinated across colleges with the College of Information Co-Director to set up advising, teaching workload, and major requirements for students. | <p>College Park, MD
Oct 2021 – present
4 years 6 months</p> |
| <p>Director of Graduate Studies
<i>Joint Program in Survey Methodology (JPSM), University of Maryland</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Oversaw updates to the Master's in Survey and Data Science program, including adding SURV613: Machine Learning for Social Science as a required course and incorporating neural networks and LLMs into course material. Assisted graduate students in finding funding through grants or teaching assistant opportunities on campus. Chaired the Master's Admissions committee and coordinated with the Director of JPSM on recruitment efforts. | <p>College Park, MD
Sept 2024 – present
1 year 7 months</p> |
| <p>Associate Research Professor
<i>Social Data Science; Joint Program in Survey Methodology</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Developed and implemented innovative teaching assignments and tools including: cloud-based programming workbooks using JupyterHub (multiple classes); a board game decision analysis project for an undergraduate class (INST 354: Decision Making for Information Science); a data disclosure-proofing project (SURV 622: Fundamentals of Data Collection); and a custom R package containing tutorials (SURV 613: Machine Learning for Social Science). Taught classes on introductory statistics, data science, machine learning, and programming for both undergraduate and graduate students, utilizing traditional and flipped classroom formats in online, in-person, and HyFlex modes. | <p>College Park, MD
July 2024 – present
1 year 9 months</p> |

Assistant Research Professor <i>Social Data Science; Joint Program in Survey Methodology</i>	College Park, MD Aug 2020 – July 2024 4 years
Lecturer <i>Joint Program in Survey Methodology, University of Maryland</i>	College Park, MD Oct 2017 – Aug 2020 2 years 11 months
Consultant/Facilitator <i>The Coleridge Initiative</i> • Provided guidance as a facilitator with the Applied Data Analytics program for teaching record linkage, text analysis, network analysis, and machine learning to working professionals in public policy. • Consulted on a research projects using machine learning for imputation with large scale transaction-level purchasing data. • Developed modularized lessons and notebooks for introductory statistics and programming in Python, R and SQL.	Sept 2020 – Jan 2022 1 year 5 months
Statistical Consultant <i>UCLA Institute for Digital Research and Education</i> • Assisted graduate students and professors in Psychology, Economics, Education, and other fields in cleaning, merging, and preparing data for analysis. • Helped clients with their dissertations, publications, and other projects using methods such as mixed modeling, principal components analysis, simulation, and more using a variety of statistical software.	Los Angeles, CA May 2014 – June 2016 2 years 2 months
Academic Mentor <i>UCLA Institute for Pure and Applied Mathematics</i> • Mentored a team of four undergraduate students with a research project for the Research in Industrial Projects for Students (RIPS) summer program in which an industry sponsor provides a real problem of interest. • Provided a cooperative team environment for research by encouraging collaboration between students and advising students throughout the full research lifecycle.	UCLA 2015 – 2017 2 years

Publications

Using a Stopping Rule to Optimize Cost-Quality Tradeoffs in a Large, Mixed-Mode Survey: A Simulation Study <i>J. Wagner, B. West, B. Kim, D. Suolang, C. Engstrom, J. Sinibaldi</i> Journal of Official Statistics. 41 (1), 329-364 www.doi.org/10.1177/0282423X241287452	2025
Hidden Population Size Estimation and Diagnostics Using Two Respondent-Driven Samples with Applications in Armenia <i>B. Kim, L. G. Johnston, T. Grigoryan, A. Papoyan, S. Grigoryan, K. R. McLaughlin</i> Biometrical Journal, 00, 2200136 www.doi.org/10.1002/bimj.202200136	2023
Using Geographical Data and Rolling Statistics for Diagnostics of Respondent-Driven Sampling <i>B. Kim, M. Ogwal, E. Sande, H. Kiyingi, D. Serwadda, W. Hladik</i> Social Networks. 69, 74-83 www.doi.org/10.1016/j.socnet.2020.05.001	2022

- Population Size Estimation Using Multiple Respondent-Driven Sampling Surveys** 2021
B. Kim, M. Handcock
 Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology. 9(1), 94-120
www.doi.org/10.1093/jssam/smz055
- Easy-to-Use Cloud Computing for Teaching Data Science** 2020
B. Kim, G. Henke
 Journal of Statistics Education. 29:sup1, S103-S111
www.doi.org/10.1080/10691898.2020.1860726
- Partnering with a global platform to inform research and public policy making** 2020
F. Kreuter, N. Barkay, A. Bilinski, A. Bradford, S. Chiu, R. Eliat, J. Fan, T. Galili, D. Haimovich, B. Kim, S. LaRocca, Y. Li, K. Morris, S. Presser, T. Sarig, J. A. Salomon, K. Stewart, E. A. Stuart, R. Tibshirani
 Survey Research Methods, 14(2), 159-163
www.doi.org/10.18148/srm/2020.v14i2.7761

Software and Data

- sspse: Estimating Hidden Population Size using Respondent Driven Sampling Data** 2022
M. Handcock, K. Gile, B. Kim, K. McLaughlin
 R package version 1.0.3, Los Angeles, CA.
cran.r-project.org/package=sspse
- The University of Maryland social data science center global COVID-19 trends and impact survey, in partnership with Facebook** 2020
J. Fan, Y. Li, K. Stewart, A. R. Kommareddy, A. Garcia, J. O'Brien, A. Bradford, X. Deng, S. Chiu, F. Kreuter, N. Barkay, A. Bilinski, B. Kim, T. Galili, D. Haimovich, S. LaRocca, S. Presser, K. Morris, J. Salomon, D. Vannette
 University of Maryland
covidmap.umd.edu/api.html

Book Chapters and Non-Refereed Publications

- The Value of Science: Special Theme** 2022
J. Lane, B. Kim, F. Kreuter, A. Nunez
 Harvard Data Science Review. Issue 4.2
[10.1162/99608f92.4a01213d](https://doi.org/10.1162/99608f92.4a01213d)
- Scaling Up Data Science for the Social Sciences** 2021
B. Kim
 Harvard Data Science Review. Issue 3.2
[10.1162/99608f92.d3f14ea4](https://doi.org/10.1162/99608f92.d3f14ea4)
- Workbooks** 2021
B. Kim, C. Kern, J. Morgan, C. Hunter, A. Kumar
 Big Data and Social Science, 2nd Edition. Chapman and Hall/CRC Press. 333-339
textbook.coleridgeinitiative.org/chap-workbooks.html

Selected Conference Presentations

- A Hybrid Household and Respondent-Driven Sampling Strategy for Reaching Underrepresented Groups** August 2023
B. Kim, A. Gard
 Joint Statistical Meetings, Toronto, CA

Machine Learning Model Selection for Complex Sample Survey Data B. Kim Symposium on Data Science and Statistics	August 2020
Data 8 Adoption at University of Maryland B. Kim National Workshop on Data Science Education, Berkeley, CA	June 2020
Population Size Estimation Using Multiple Respondent-Driven Sampling Surveys B. Kim, M. Handcock Joint Statistical Meetings, Denver, CO	August 2019
Teaching Data Science Using Jupyter Notebooks and Binder B. Kim Symposium on Data Science and Statistics, Bellevue, WA	May 2019
Assessing Respondent-Driven Sampling Using Geographical Data B. Kim, M. Ogwal, E. Sande, H. Kiyangi, D. Serwadda, W. Hladik North American Social Network Conference, Washington, D.C.	November 2018

Grants and Awards

Advancing Computational Expertise in Neuroscience and Psychology (co-PI) UMD Artificial Intelligence Interdisciplinary Institute: Course Development Grant Funding: \$10,000	May 2025 – May 2026
Cloud-based Active Learning for BSOS Statistics and Data Science Courses (PI) UMD Teaching and Learning Transformation Center: Experiential Learning Grant Funding: \$135,573.72	Sept 2022 – Aug 2023
An Evaluation of Sampling Methodologies for Reaching Underrepresented Groups (PI) University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative Funding: \$19,999	June 2022 – May 2023
Global Privacy Monitor (GPM): Learning from External Privacy Stakeholders Facebook, Inc. Funding: \$2,994,731	June 2021 – May 2024
Modernizing NCSES Data Collection Approaches (co-PI) National Science Foundation, NCSES BAA Funding: \$88,802	Sept 2020 – Aug 2021
Collaborative Research: Impacts of Hard/Soft Skills on STEM Workforce Trajectories (co-PI) National Science Foundation, ECR: 1956114 Funding: \$401,716	May 2020 – May 2025
Linked Dataset and Virtual Research Data Center (Co-PI) National Agricultural Statistics Service Funding: \$653,490	Aug 2019 – Feb 2024
Teaching Innovations Grant University of Maryland Funding: \$18,000	June 2020 – Aug 2020

Teaching Innovations Grant University of Maryland Funding: \$5,000	June 2020 – Aug 2020
Developing a New Course in Data Science: Introduction to Data Science for Social Sciences (PI) UMD Year of Data Science Funding: \$17,500	July 2019 – May 2020
Feasibility Testing of a Respondent-Driven Sampling Approach to Recruit Human Trafficking Victims Governor's Office of Crime Control and Prevention Funding: \$30,000	Dec 2018 – July 2019
Dissertation Year Fellowship University of California, Los Angeles	2016 – 2016
Collegium of University Teaching Fellows University of California, Los Angeles	2016 – 2016
Graduate Dean's Scholar Award University of California, Los Angeles	2012 – 2014

Other Academic Work

Guest Editor Harvard Data Science Review, Special Theme: Value of Science. Issue 4.2.	2022 – 2022
Reviewer - Journal of Statistics and Data Science Education - Journal of Survey Statistics and Methodology - Journal of Statistical Software - Public Opinion Quarterly - Harvard Data Science Review - Computational Statistics and Data Analysis - Journal of Official Statistics	2018 – present

Teaching

Instructor

Oct 2017 – present

University of Maryland

- SDSB180: **Introduction to Data Management** (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- SDSB123: **Social Data Science: Pathways and Applications** (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- SDSB326: **Python Programming for Social Science** (Spring 2024)
- SDSB233: **Data Science for Social Sciences** (Fall 2019, Spring 2020, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023)
- INST 314: **Statistics for Information Science** (Fall 2018)
- INST 354: **Decision Making for Information Science** (Spring 2019)
- SURV 613: **Machine Learning for Social Sciences** (Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026)
- SURV 622: **Fundamentals of Data Collection** (Spring 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2022)
- SURV 673: **Introduction to Python & SQL** (Fall 2018, Spring 2019, Summer 2019, Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Summer 2020, Summer 2021)
- SURV 699M: **Review of Statistical Concepts** (Summer 2018, Summer 2019, Summer 2020, Summer 2021)
- SURV 701: **Analysis of Complex Sample Survey Data** (Spring 2021)
- SURV 727: **Fundamentals of Computing and Data Display** (Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
- SURV 736: **Introduction to Web Scraping with R** (Summer 2025)

Instructor

Jan 2017 – Mar 2017

University of California, Los Angeles

- Stat 98T: **Six Degrees of Separation: Studying the World Through Social Networks** (Winter 2017)

Teaching Assistant

Sept 2013 – June 2016

University of California, Los Angeles

- Stat 10: **Introduction to Statistical Reasoning** (Fall 2013, Winter 2014, Spring 2014, Fall 2014, Winter 2015, Spring 2015, Fall 2015, Winter 2016, Spring 2016)

Mentorship

Doctoral Students

Advisor

- Harold Gomes (expected 2026)

Doctoral Committee

Committee Member

- Yuting Chen, University of Maryland (2025)
- Ai Rene Ong, University of Michigan (2022)
- Jordan Epistola, University of Maryland (2022)

Graduate Students on Funded Projects

Supervisor

- Namit Shrivastava (January 2026 – May 2026)
- Ujjayini Das (September 2022 – August 2023)
- Joseph Hoskisson (September 2022 – August 2023)
- Franklin Yang (September 2021 – August 2022)
- Sofi Sinozich (September 2020 – August 2021)

Undergraduate Capstone Projects

Faculty Mentor

- Pragma Kumar, Orla Collins, Giulia Hoorens van Heyningen (2026) *Assessing the Viability of Weighting Methods for Hybrid Sampling Design*
- Danny Pham, Tariq Witherspoon, Andrew Shin (2026) *Machine Learning Model Selection with Complex Sample Survey Data*

Service

- Faculty Coordinator, Joint Program in Survey Methodology Short Course Program
- Co-Chair, Social Data Science Program Committee
- Co-Chair, Department of Psychology Lecturer Search Committee
- Chair, Social Data Science Curriculum Committee
- Chair, Search Committee for Executive Director of the Center for Advances in Data and Measurement
- Member/Chair, JPSM/MPSM Masters Admissions Committee
- Member, Department of Economics Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, Department of Criminology and Criminal Justice Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, College of Information Studies Lecturer Search Committee
- Member, Social Data Science Advisor Search Committee
- Member, Social Data Science Steering Committee
- Member, JPSM/MPSM Teaching Assignment Committee

Skills

Statistical Software

Highly skilled in R, SQL and Python, including various packages such as Rcpp, caret, tidyverse, tidymodels, and more (in R); and pandas, scikit-learn, nltk, tensorflow, keras, and more (in Python).

Statistics

Highly skilled in a variety of methods, including but not limited to hypothesis testing, regression, mixed models, clustering analysis, social network analysis, social network models, network sampling methods, Monte Carlo simulation, Bayesian models, Machine Learning, text analysis, web scraping, and more.

Other Software

Skilled or proficient in the use of many other programs, including, but not limited to, Microsoft Word, Excel and Powerpoint; LaTeX.